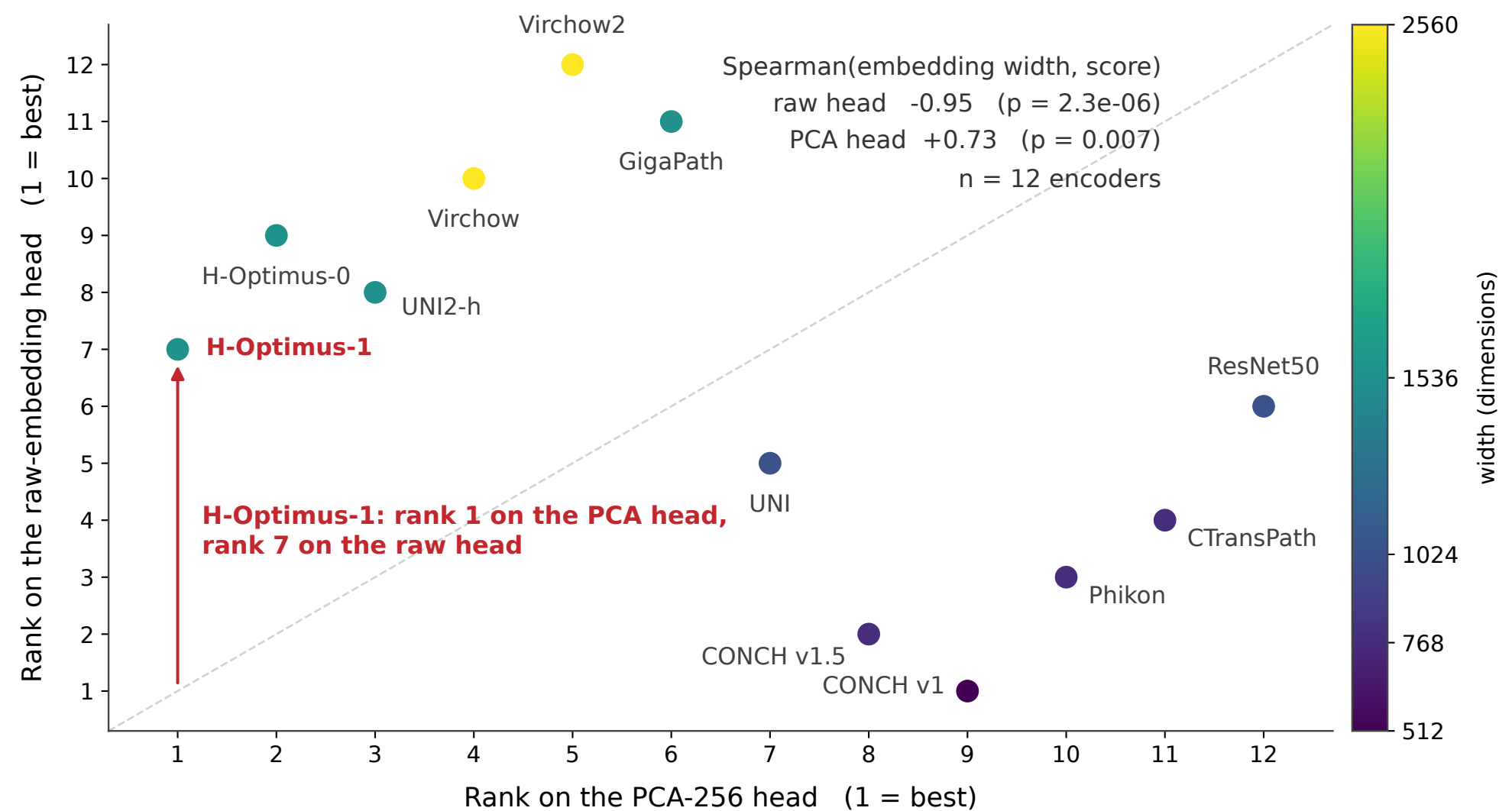




12 encoders, cohort: round 2, with H-optimus-1 added by R8. The dashed line is equal rank on both heads; points below it rank better on the raw head. On raw embeddings the Gram matrix is effectively singular at the benchmark's fixed alpha; the PCA head projects every encoder to 256 dimensions first and the width effect reverses sign. Rank-versus-rank Spearman -0.601 (p = 0.039).